

ALCANCE AVIATION

CLEARED FOR THE INTERVIEW

The Complete Pilot Interview Preparation Guide

Airline · Cargo · Fractional · Corporate



BY

ALCANCE AVIATION



CLEARED FOR THE INTERVIEW

The Complete Pilot Interview Preparation Guide

A comprehensive resource for pilots preparing for airline, cargo, fractional, and corporate aviation interviews worldwide.

Alcance Aviation



□ How to Use This Book

This guide is organized into 10 chapters covering every aspect of a professional pilot interview — from personal background questions to advanced technical knowledge.

Start with Chapter 1 and work through each section. Do not skip ahead to the technical chapters without reviewing the HR and behavioral chapters first. Interviewers eliminate most candidates on the HR portion, not the technical.

Use the TMAAT chapter (Chapter 6) to prepare your stories BEFORE the interview. Write them down using the STAR method and practice them out loud.

The Technical Study Guide (Chapter 7) covers concepts asked at airlines, cargo operators, fractional companies, and corporate flight departments worldwide.

All questions in this guide are drawn from real interviews conducted at aviation companies around the world. No company names are used to protect the integrity of the material.



ABOUT ALCANCE AVIATION

Founded and led by Alessandro Ruppel Rolim

Alcance Aviation was built on a simple idea: the pilots most qualified to prepare you for an interview are the ones who have lived them — on both sides of the table.

Alessandro Ruppel Rolim, the founder of Alcance Aviation, started flying at sixteen. By nineteen, he was in the right seat of a Cessna Citation. At twenty-four, he landed his first airline job on the Boeing 737-300 and -400. From there, he helped launch a low-fare carrier operating the 737-700 and -800, before expatriating to China, where he flew the Airbus A320 and A330 for seventeen years.

When COVID-19 brought global aviation to a halt, Ruppel relocated to the United States, where he currently flies for a U.S. carrier and serves as a simulator instructor on the Boeing 737-300, -400, and -700.

That path — from charter to airline, single-aisle to widebody, across three continents — is the foundation of the coaching methodology behind this book.

Why Alcance exists

Alcance Aviation started the way most meaningful things do: out of frustration. After paying a premium for interview coaching that fell short, Ruppel set out to build something better — a preparation approach rooted in real cockpit experience, current hiring standards, and the specific patterns interviewers actually use.

Today, Alcance Aviation coaches pilots preparing for airline, cargo, fractional, and corporate interviews around the world. We have never run an advertisement. Our students come through referrals from other pilots who have sat in our sessions and, more importantly, landed the job. That pipeline has kept our online classes continuously booked.

Why this book

Thousands of coaching hours made one thing clear: the questions repeat, the patterns are predictable, and preparation — not luck — is what separates the pilots who get hired from the ones who do not. This book distills those patterns into a single, focused resource, so that any pilot preparing for an interview has access to the same structured preparation our students do.

Your uniform is earned the day you are hired. This book is here to help you earn it.





INTRODUCTION

There is a myth in aviation that some pilots are simply “good at interviews.” That the charismatic ones walk in, say the right things, and walk out with an offer — while the rest grind through sim evaluations and technical questions, hoping their logbook speaks for itself.

It is a comforting story. It is also wrong.

After thousands of coaching hours across airline, cargo, fractional, and corporate interviews, one thing is clear: the pilots who get hired are not the ones with the best stories or the smoothest delivery. They are the ones who prepared for the pattern. Interviews repeat. The questions repeat. The way interviewers score answers repeats. Preparation — not personality — is what closes the gap between a qualified pilot and a hired pilot.

This book is built on that pattern. Ten chapters cover what every serious interview will test you on: personal background, company fit, background checks, CRM and safety, leadership, TMAAT behavioral questions, technical knowledge, weather, regulations and airspace, and scenario-based problem solving. Every question in this book has been asked — recently — in a real interview. Study them out loud. Answer them until your answers feel natural, not rehearsed. Use the STAR method where it fits. And never lie — interviewers check.

Your uniform is earned the day you are hired. This book is here to help you earn it.

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Chapter 1

Personal & Background

□ These questions open almost every interview. Know your story cold. Walk through your resume chronologically, keep it aviation-focused, and end with why you are here today.

1. Tell me about yourself / Who are you?
2. How did you get into aviation / flying?
3. Walk me through your resume / aviation career.
4. What are your strengths?
5. What is your biggest weakness?
6. What are your best and worst characteristics?
7. What are your strengths and weaknesses?
8. What do you do in your free time / outside of work?
9. Where do you see yourself in 5 years?
10. Tell me about your most memorable flight.
11. Tell me about a time you had an emergency or bad experience while flying.
12. Tell me about a flight you wish you hadn't gone on.
13. Tell me about a time you had to think quickly / make an instant decision.
14. Tell me about a time you had to take a leadership position.
15. Tell me about a time you went above and beyond.
16. Tell me about a time you received constructive criticism.
17. Tell me about a time you learned from a mistake or failure.
18. Tell me about a time you disagreed with a superior — what did you do?
19. Tell me about a time you had a conflict with a colleague or supervisor.
20. Tell me about a time you had to make a critical decision under pressure.



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21. Tell me about a time you dealt with a coworker who was not following SOP.
 22. Tell me about a time you helped a customer directly.
 23. Tell me about a time you helped a co-worker outside of flying duties.
 24. Tell me about a challenging flight.
 25. Tell me about a time you flew with a difficult Captain — how did you handle it?
 26. Tell me about a time you flew with someone you didn't enjoy — how did you handle it?
 27. Tell me about a time when you had a conflict with someone in the cockpit.
 28. Tell me about a time when poor CRM led to a mistake or near miss. What did you learn?
 29. Tell me about a time a breakdown in SOP occurred.
 30. Tell me something others might have a misconception about you.
 31. What was your worst day in aviation?
 32. What was your best day in aviation?
 33. What was the hardest decision you had to make in the cockpit?
 34. What is your most valuable trait as a pilot / instructor?
 35. What are your pet peeves in the cockpit?
 36. What do you consider your most memorable experience in an airplane?
 37. Tell me about the pilot you admire the most.
 38. Have you had any mentors throughout your career?
 39. Have you passed a student that you regretted?
 40. What is your favorite topic to instruct/teach?
 41. Tell me about your most influential instructor.
 42. What song would best describe you?
 43. What is the last book you read?
 44. What are your hobbies?



45. What is your favorite funny / comedy movie?

46. What makes you happy?

47. What makes you upset or angry?

48. 5 adjectives that describe you.

49. Do you think of work as a performance?

50. What was your favorite job you've had so far?



Chapter 2

Company Fit & Motivation

□ **Research the company thoroughly before your interview. Know their fleet, culture, schedule, domiciles, and what makes them unique. “Why our company?” is the most important question you will be asked.**

1. Why do you want to fly for our company?
2. Why should we hire you?
3. Why should we hire you over other qualified applicants?
4. What will you bring to this company?
5. What do you know about us? Have you listened to our podcasts or talked with our pilots?
6. What do you like about your current job?
7. What frustrates you about your current company?
8. Why did you leave your previous company?
9. Have you applied elsewhere? Who have you applied to?
10. What would you do if another company called and offered you a job at the same time?
11. If they call you in 8 months, are you going to go with one of them?
12. Are you familiar with our schedules?
13. How will your family deal with our schedules?
14. How do you feel about being on the road for extended periods?
15. How will you prepare for training if you get hired?
16. Do you think you will have any issues with training on a new aircraft?
17. What would be the toughest / hardest part about transitioning here?
18. What is your biggest challenge coming here?
19. What will be challenging for you if you're hired?



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20. Are you ok with sitting in the right seat for a while / extended time to upgrade?
 21. Would you have a problem being a First Officer after being a Captain for years?
 22. How would you feel about flying with a Captain younger than you?
 23. Where do you see yourself in 5 years with this company?
 24. Do you have any questions for us?
 25. How do you think you did on the interview?
 26. How do we know you're not going to leave after training?
 27. What would you do if you didn't get the job?
 28. Would the long trips we do be a problem for you?
 29. Can you accept an immediate training date?
 30. Would you need to give your current employer 2 weeks notice?
 31. Did you leave your previous employers on good terms?
 32. Have you thought about the financial challenges of the first year?
 33. What equipment / aircraft would you like and why?
 34. What are your long-term goals?
 35. What is the option if not this company?
 36. What is one thing about coming here that you have bad feelings about?
 37. Do you like working for your current company and why are you leaving?
 38. Tell me why you left a previous job.
 39. Why don't you want to work for an airline under Part 121?
 40. Why are you moving from Part 121 to Part 135?
 41. Based on your resume it looks like you could go to a major — so why here?
 42. What is the difference between good service and elite service?
 43. How do you feel about going back to being a First Officer?
 44. How do you feel about the negative aspects of this job?



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45. Would you be okay driving a rental car for several hours to get to or from a trip?
46. We try to stay in nice hotels, but occasionally only a smoking/handicap room may be available. Are you okay resting in that environment?
47. Are you okay with — lifting bags, driving rental cars 5-7 hours, cleaning the cabin, flying smokers/pets, fueling/servicing the jet, staying in a less-than-ideal hotel?
48. Do you have any problem with passengers smoking on the aircraft or exotic pets on board?
49. Do you realize that you'll have to clean a lav, load bags, hold the dog, vacuum the airplane, wipe fingerprints, etc.?
50. Do you think what you wear to work is a uniform or costume?
51. What would be any obstacles that could keep you from moving to your base?
52. Will you move to your base?
53. Are you okay with 8-day trips?
54. What crew base would you prefer?
55. How did you prepare for this interview?



Chapter 3

Background Check & Records

□ Always be honest. Interviewers have seen everything. A disclosed issue handled professionally is far better than one that is discovered later. Never lie on your application or in the interview.

1. Have you had any training failures or required extra sim lessons?
2. Have you failed any check rides?
3. Have you had any accidents, incidents, or violations?
4. Have you had any FAA / regulatory violations?
5. They asked about criminal history.
6. Have you ever been arrested?
7. They asked about driving violations.
8. Can you pass a drug test?
9. Can you pass a security / background check?
10. Do you have anything in your past that we might find in the background check?
11. Were you ever fired or forced to resign?
12. Were you ever taken off flying duties?
13. Did the tower ever ask you to call a number after you land?
14. Have you ever had to call in fatigue? What was the situation?
15. Are you currently employed with a flying job?
16. What are the gaps in your employment?
17. When was your last line check?
18. How did you accumulate all of your flight hours?
19. Where did you receive your flight training?
20. What are you currently flying?



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21. How much flight time do you have in a crewed aircraft?
 22. How soon are you available for training?
 23. Will you resign from your current employer?
 24. Have you ever been late to a flight, hotel van, or crew bus?
 25. Tell me about a time you broke a FAR or company SOP.
 26. We do an extensive background check — is there anything you want to tell us about?
 27. Is there anything that would embarrass yourself or the company that we would find on Google?
 28. Have you ever been grounded from flying?
 29. Have you ever deviated from SOPs?
 30. Have you had any moving violations in an automobile?



Chapter 4

CRM, Safety & Airmanship

□ **Safety is non-negotiable. Never compromise it for schedule, passenger pressure, or a captain's request. Show interviewers that you know when and how to speak up.**

□ Crew Resource Management (CRM)

1. Can you define Crew Resource Management and explain its importance in aviation?
2. What does CRM mean to you?
3. What is the difference between CRM and TEM?
4. Describe a situation where effective communication helped prevent a potential issue during a flight.
5. How do you handle disagreements or conflicts in a multi-crew environment?
6. How do you ensure that all crew members feel comfortable speaking up, especially junior ones?
7. What role does assertiveness play in CRM, and how do you balance it with respect for authority?
8. How do you apply CRM principles during abnormal or emergency situations?
9. What strategies do you use to maintain situational awareness as a crew?
10. How do you debrief after a flight to improve CRM and overall performance?
11. Have you ever seen CRM break down in the cockpit?
12. Tell me about a time you used CRM to resolve a crew member conflict.
13. Tell me about a time you overcame a difficult situation using CRM.
14. How do you manage an emergency as it relates to CRM?
15. Who is responsible for safety of flight of the aircraft?

△ Threat and Error Management (TEM)

1. Can you explain Threat and Error Management and how it applies to daily flight operations?



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2. Describe a time when you identified a threat before it became a problem.
 3. Have you ever made an error in flight? How did you recognize it and mitigate it?
 4. What types of threats do you consider during pre-flight planning?
 5. How do you manage errors made by other crew members without compromising safety or teamwork?
 6. Can you give an example of an undesired aircraft state and how you corrected it?
 7. How do you ensure minor errors don't escalate into major incidents?
 8. What role does communication play in managing threats and errors?

Safety & Airmanship Scenarios

1. What would you do if your Captain was violating a safety protocol?
2. What would you do if the Captain shows up drunk / intoxicated?
3. What would you do if the Captain wanted to take off below minimums without a takeoff alternate?
4. What would you do if the Captain continues below DA without required visual reference and refuses to go missed?
5. What would you do if the Captain wanted to delay writing up a maintenance item?
6. What would you do if the Captain wanted to fly with a broken armrest?
7. What would you do if the Captain wanted to pretend the NAV light was fine until reaching home base?
8. What would you do if you and your Captain notice the only lavatory is on MEL for a 4.5-hour flight?
9. What would you do if the Captain is flying an ILS and is approaching full-scale deflection low on the GS and does not respond?
10. What would you do if your FO falls asleep on an early morning departure?
11. What would you do if you're fatigued to the point of being unsafe — would you still fly?
12. Your captain tries to convince you to fly even though you called in fatigued. What do you say?



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- 13. Captain throws the checklist in the back and says “To hell with the SOP” — what do you do?**
 - 14. Tell about a situation where you put safety first.**
 - 15. How do you ensure your decisions are aligned with safety protocols and operational guidelines?**
 - 16. How do you maintain the highest standards of safety and professionalism while on duty?**
 - 17. How do you handle stress and fatigue during long or demanding flights?**
 - 18. How do you manage stress and fatigue?**
 - 19. How do you deal with complacency?**
 - 20. Have you ever declared an emergency?**
 - 21. Have you ever taken the controls from another pilot? If so, explain the situation.**



Chapter 5

Leadership & Communication

□ **Leadership in the cockpit is not about rank — it's about creating an environment where the best decision always wins. Show that you lead by example.**

1. What do you think makes a good First Officer?
2. What are 3 qualities of a good First Officer?
3. What qualities make a good Captain?
4. What attributes make a good Captain?
5. What makes a good leader in the cockpit?
6. Of those attributes, which is your strongest and weakest?
7. Tell me about a time when you had to take a leadership role unexpectedly.
8. What qualities make you a good leader in the cockpit?
9. Can you share an example of how you effectively collaborated with a diverse crew?
10. How do you adapt your communication style for different audiences?
11. How do you ensure clear and effective communication with ATC, cabin crew, and passengers?
12. How would you handle a passenger exhibiting disruptive behavior during a flight?
13. What would those you've flown with say about you?
14. If I call your references, what 3 words might they use to describe you?
15. Tell us three words that people who have flown with you would use to describe you.
16. If we brought your squadron mates / crewmates in and asked them about you, what would they say?
17. What would your Captains say about you?
18. What would your Captains say you needed to improve on?



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19. What would a previous captain have to say that is negative about you?
 20. How would you handle a young, arrogant captain?
 21. Have you ever had a captain you just didn't get along with? If so, how did you handle that?
 22. What would you do if you had a really awful client/customer on your airplane?
 23. How would you deal with a delay? Passengers are upset, already 30 min late, weather delay going longer.
 24. What are you going to tell the customer who has a multi-million dollar deal and you have to cancel the flight because the aircraft is broken?
 25. Customer has been delayed by the company for 4 hours and you show up just in time to get chewed out — how do you handle it?
 26. WWYD if you were at a remote airport and corporate says "Tell the owner the catering company dropped the ball, not us." The owners are driving up right now.
 27. How would you deal with an intoxicated passenger?
 28. You have 8 passengers that show up with bags that clearly won't fit — walk us through how you would handle this situation.
 29. How do you build rapport with people in the company?
 30. What steps do you take to foster a positive and respectful working environment?

Simulator Instructor Questions

1. Can you explain how you troubleshoot a simulator when it's not functioning correctly?
2. How do you ensure that the simulator software and hardware stay updated?
3. What protocols do you follow to maintain simulator accuracy and reliability?
4. How would you adapt your teaching style to match the needs of different learners?
5. Can you describe how you assess a trainee's performance during simulations?
6. How do you keep trainees engaged during lengthy simulation sessions?
7. Imagine a trainee is consistently struggling to grasp certain concepts. How would you handle this?



8. How would you respond if technical issues disrupted a training session with tight deadlines?

9. Have you ever encountered resistance from trainees in accepting feedback? How did you overcome it?

10. What do you consider your most valuable trait as a simulator instructor?

11. Can you share a time when you went above and beyond to ensure the success of a trainee?

12. How do you foster a positive and productive training environment?

13. Can you share a time when you had to manage conflicts between trainees?

14. How do you communicate complex technical concepts to trainees with limited technical backgrounds?

15. Have you ever faced an unexpected challenge during a simulation session? How did you resolve it?

16. How do you prioritize tasks when balancing simulator maintenance and conducting training sessions?

17. Can you give an example of how you modified or improved a simulation scenario for better training?

18. How do you stay updated on new simulation technologies and techniques?

19. Have you ever suggested or implemented improvements to the simulator systems? What was the outcome?

20. How do you incorporate emerging trends in simulation training into your sessions?

21. How do you ensure trainees understand the objectives of a simulation exercise?

22. How do you measure the success of your training sessions?

23. What is your approach to providing constructive feedback to trainees?





Chapter 5B

The STAR Method — How to Answer Behavioral Questions

One of the most common reasons pilots fail airline interviews is not a lack of experience — it is a lack of storytelling. They have done incredible things in the cockpit but cannot communicate them clearly under pressure.

The STAR Method solves this problem. It is a simple four-step framework that transforms a rambling answer into a powerful, structured story that interviewers remember.

Every TMAAT question in Chapter 6 should be answered using this method. Learn it, practice it, and own it before you walk into any interview room.

□ What Does STAR Stand For?

S — Situation: Set the scene. Where were you? What was happening? Give enough context so the interviewer understands the environment.

T — Task: What was your specific role or responsibility in that situation? What were you expected to do?

A — Action: What did YOU specifically do? This is the most important part. Do not say “we” — say “I.” Be specific about your actions, your words, your decisions.

R — Result: What happened as a result of your actions? What did you learn? How did it affect the crew, the flight, or the company?

□ **Keep each STAR answer between 90 seconds and 2 minutes when spoken aloud. Practice out loud — not just in your head.**

□ Why Interviewers Love the STAR Method

Airline and fractional interviewers are trained to evaluate behavioral competencies. They are not just listening to your answer — they are listening for evidence of specific traits: leadership, communication, safety awareness, customer service, and resilience.

A STAR answer gives them exactly what they need. It is organized, credible, and easy to evaluate. A rambling answer without structure leaves the interviewer guessing and creates doubt.

Think of it this way: the interviewer has already talked to 10 pilots that day. Most gave vague answers like “I handled it professionally” or “we worked it out as a team.” Your STAR answer will stand out because it is specific, real, and memorable.

⚠ The 5 Most Common STAR Mistakes

Mistake 1 — Using “We” Instead of “I”



Interviewers want to know what YOU did. Saying “we handled the emergency” tells them nothing. Say “I called out the malfunction, I took the controls, I declared the emergency.”

⚠ Every action in your story must be something YOU did. Save “we” only for the outcome.

Mistake 2 — Being Too Vague

❑ I had a conflict with a captain once and we resolved it professionally.

This answer is useless to an interviewer. It has no situation, no action, no result. It tells them nothing about how you actually behave.

❑ We were on final into KJFK, the captain was 200 ft below our briefed glidepath and not responding to my callouts. I said clearly: ‘Captain, we are low, I recommend go-around.’ He initiated the go-around immediately. After landing we debriefed and he thanked me for speaking up.

Mistake 3 — Talking Too Long

Some pilots get nervous and over-explain. A STAR answer should be tight — 90 seconds to 2 minutes. If you are still talking after 3 minutes, you have lost the interviewer. Practice cutting your stories down to the essential details only.

❑ **If your story takes more than 2 minutes to tell out loud, cut the Situation shorter. The Action and Result are what matter most.**

Mistake 4 — Choosing a Weak Story

Not all stories are equal. A story about resolving a minor scheduling conflict is far weaker than a story about a genuine in-flight emergency or a safety confrontation with a captain. Choose stories that demonstrate real competency under real pressure.

Before your interview, prepare at least one strong STAR story for each of these categories: conflict with a superior, safety decision, customer service, leadership, mistake you learned from, and going above and beyond.

Mistake 5 — No Result

Many pilots give a great Situation and Action but forget the Result. The Result is what closes the loop. It shows the interviewer that your actions actually worked — or more importantly, that you learned something when they did not.

⚠ Even if the outcome was not perfect, a result that includes a lesson learned is still powerful. Interviewers respect self-awareness.

❑ Full STAR Answer Examples

Example 1 — TMAAT You Had a Conflict With a Captain



Question: “Tell me about a time you had a conflict with a captain and how you resolved it.”

S — Situation: We were operating a charter flight from Miami to Nassau. Weather at destination was deteriorating faster than forecast, and our filed alternate was already below minimums.

T — Task: I was the First Officer and responsible for monitoring fuel and weather. I noticed we were approaching a point where our options would become very limited.

A — Action: I brought my concern to the captain calmly and clearly: ‘Captain, Nassau is now reporting 400 overcast and our alternate is below minimums. I recommend we discuss our fuel options before we pass our last divert point.’ He initially wanted to continue, confident the weather would improve. I acknowledged his experience, but respectfully asked that we review the METAR one more time together. When he saw the trend, he agreed to divert.

R — Result: We diverted safely with comfortable fuel reserves. The weather at Nassau never improved. After the flight, the captain told me I had done exactly the right thing by speaking up when I did. It reinforced for me that respectful assertiveness is not a challenge to authority — it is part of good CRM.

□ **Notice how this answer uses “I” throughout the Action, includes the specific weather details, and ends with a lesson learned. This is what a strong STAR answer looks like.**

Example 2 — TMAAT You Provided Exceptional Customer Service

Question: “Tell me about a time you went above and beyond for a customer.”

S — Situation: We had just landed at a small regional airport after a fractional owner’s trip. As we were completing our shutdown checklist, my FO noticed a travel bag left in the aft cabin. The owner had already departed in his car and was heading to a lake house several hours away.

T — Task: As Captain, I had to decide how to handle the situation. We had no scheduled flights for the rest of the day.

A — Action: I called the owner directly, informed him we had found his bag, and told him I would personally drive it to him. I got his address and made the two-hour drive to his lake house that evening.

R — Result: The owner was genuinely surprised and grateful. He later sent a letter to the company praising the crew. That interaction led to him referring two of his business partners to the program. For me, it confirmed that in private aviation, the experience we create off the aircraft is just as important as the flight itself.

Example 3 — TMAAT You Made a Mistake and What You Learned

Question: “Tell me about a time you made a mistake. What did you learn?”



S — Situation: Early in my career, I was flying a Part 135 cargo run on a tight schedule. We were departing from a small airport and I was under self-induced pressure to make our slot time.

T — Task: I was the Captain and Pilot Flying. My responsibility was to complete all pre-departure checks before taxi.

A — Action: In my rush, I abbreviated my walkaround. I missed that the fuel cap on the right wing was not fully secured. As I was taxiing out, a line technician ran toward the aircraft waving his arms. I stopped immediately and shut down. The fuel cap was loose and fuel had been venting.

R — Result: We missed our slot time, but we did not have a serious incident. I wrote a safety report, briefed my chief pilot, and personally apologized to the customer. More importantly, I changed my behavior permanently. Since that day, I have never rushed a walkaround regardless of schedule pressure. The schedule exists to serve safety — not the other way around.

⚠ When answering mistake questions, never blame others, never minimize what happened, and always include what you changed as a result. Interviewers are not looking for perfection — they are looking for self-awareness and growth.

Example 4 — TMAAT You Had to Make a Decision Under Pressure

Question: “Tell me about a time you had to make a critical decision under pressure.”

S — Situation: We were at FL350 on a transatlantic route when we received an ECAM alert indicating a hydraulic system pressure loss. The timing was difficult — we were two hours from our destination and three hours from our departure airport.

T — Task: As First Officer, my role was to support the Captain, run the appropriate checklists, and provide accurate information so we could make the best decision together.

A — Action: I called out the ECAM, identified the affected system, and ran the QRH procedure while the Captain maintained aircraft control. I assessed our nearest suitable airports, calculated fuel burn for each option, checked weather at alternates, and presented the Captain with a clear summary: three options, the tradeoffs of each, and my recommendation. I also contacted dispatch and maintenance control proactively.

R — Result: We diverted to our closest suitable airport, landed uneventfully, and the aircraft was inspected by maintenance. The hydraulic issue was a sensor fault — no actual system damage. But we made the decision based on the information we had, which was the right approach. The Captain debriefed me afterward and said the quality of the information I provided made the decision straightforward. That experience showed me how critical clear, organized communication is in high-pressure moments.

□ How to Prepare Your Own STAR Stories

Before your interview, write down at least one strong STAR story for each of the following categories. Keep them in a notebook and review them the night before.



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1. Conflict with a captain or superior
 2. A time you made a mistake and what you learned
 3. A time you went above and beyond for a customer / passenger
 4. A time you had to make a critical decision under pressure
 5. A time you showed leadership unexpectedly
 6. A time you identified a safety threat before it became a problem
 7. A time you had to work with someone you found difficult
 8. A time you received constructive criticism and how you responded
 9. A time you had an emergency in flight
 10. A time you went above and beyond for a co-worker or trainee

□ Write each story on a single index card or note. Include the key facts: aircraft type, airport, your role, the specific actions you took, and the result. Review them the day before your interview.

✦ Quick Reference — The STAR Checklist

Before you finish each STAR answer, ask yourself these four questions:

- ✓ Did I clearly set the scene? (Situation)
- ✓ Did I explain what MY role and responsibility was? (Task)
- ✓ Did I use “I” throughout my actions — not “we”? (Action)
- ✓ Did I close the loop with a concrete result or lesson learned? (Result)
- ✓ Did I keep the answer under 2 minutes?
- ✓ Was I specific? (Aircraft type, airport, weather, exact words I used?)
- ✓ Did I avoid blaming others?
- ✓ Did I show self-awareness if the story involved a mistake?

If you can answer yes to all eight questions, your STAR answer is ready.

□ The single best way to prepare is to practice out loud with another person. Record yourself on your phone. Listen back. You will immediately hear where your answers are weak.





Chapter 5C

The 15 Most Common Interview Mistakes

Most pilots who fail aviation interviews are qualified. They have the hours, the ratings, and the experience. They fail because of avoidable mistakes that have nothing to do with flying ability.

This chapter covers the 15 most common mistakes seen in airline, fractional, cargo, and corporate aviation interviews. Read each one carefully. Many of them will feel obvious when you read them — but under the pressure of a real interview, they are surprisingly easy to make.

Awareness is the first step. Practice is the cure.

Mistake #1 — Not Researching the Company

Walking into an interview without knowing the company is the fastest way to signal that you are not serious. Interviewers always ask “What do you know about us?” or “Why do you want to fly for our company?” If your answer is generic, you will be eliminated.

Before any interview you must know: the company’s history and founding year, the fleet they operate, their routes or service areas, their culture and core values, what makes them different from competitors, and any recent news or expansions.

❑ **Weak answer:** I know you are a great company with a good reputation and a modern fleet.

❑ **Strong answer:** You pioneered the fractional ownership model and your dedicated crew program assigns the same crew to specific owners, which creates a level of consistency and personalization that sets you apart from every other fractional operator. I have spoken with several of your pilots and done extensive research on your operation — everything I have seen confirms this is the culture I want to be part of.

❑ **The Fix:** Spend at least 2-3 hours researching the company before your interview. Visit their website, listen to their podcast if they have one, and talk to pilots who work there.

Mistake #2 — Giving Vague Answers Without Specifics

Vague answers kill interviews. “I handled it professionally” and “we worked together as a team” are phrases that mean nothing to an interviewer. They have heard them a hundred times. What they want are specific details — aircraft type, airport, exact words you used, what the outcome was.

❑ **Vague:** I once had a difficult situation with a captain and we resolved it through communication.

❑ **Specific:** We were on a positioning flight into KORD in IMC. The captain wanted to continue the approach with RVR below our company minimums. I called it out clearly:



‘Captain, RVR is 1400, our minimums are 1800. I recommend we go missed.’ He agreed and we executed the missed approach.

□ **The Fix:** Every TMAAT answer needs at least: where it happened, what aircraft, what your specific role was, and what exact actions you took. Use the STAR method from Chapter 5B.

Mistake #3 — Badmouthing a Previous Employer

This is one of the most damaging mistakes a candidate can make. No matter how bad your previous company or captain was, speaking negatively about them in an interview makes YOU look unprofessional, disloyal, and difficult to work with.

Interviewers think: “If he talks about his last company this way, he will talk about us the same way in a year.”

□ **Never say this:** My last company was poorly managed, the chief pilot had no idea what he was doing, and the pay was terrible. That’s why I left.

□ **Say this instead:** I learned a tremendous amount in my previous role and I’m grateful for the experience. I’m at a point in my career where I’m looking for a company that values long-term relationships with pilots, and everything I have seen about your culture tells me this is that place.

□ **The Fix:** Always frame your reason for leaving as moving TOWARD something better — never running away from something bad. Even if the previous situation was genuinely terrible, find a professional way to describe it.

Mistake #4 — Lying or Exaggerating on the Application or in the Interview

Aviation companies do thorough background checks. They verify flight hours, check ride history, employment records, driving records, and criminal history. If you lie — even by omission — and they find out, you will be permanently disqualified. Not just from this company, but from others who share hiring data.

A disclosed issue handled with professionalism is almost always recoverable. A lie that is discovered is never recoverable.

△ **If you have a check ride failure, an incident, a violation, or any mark on your record — disclose it proactively. Prepare a brief, honest explanation and focus on what you learned. Interviewers respect honesty far more than a perfect record.**

□ **The Fix:** Before your interview, review your entire record. If anything could appear in a background check, prepare a concise, honest, professional explanation for it. Practice saying it out loud until it comes naturally.

Mistake #5 — Not Preparing for the Simulator



Many candidates prepare extensively for the HR portion of the interview and neglect the simulator. This is a serious mistake. The simulator evaluation is a significant part of your score and can eliminate you even if your HR interview was excellent.

You do not need to be perfect in the sim. Interviewers know you have never flown that specific aircraft. What they are evaluating is: your instrument scan, your ability to brief and execute a procedure, how you handle the V1 cut, and your CRM and verbal callouts.

- ❑ **Common mistake:** Showing up to the sim with no preparation, unfamiliar with the cockpit layout, and no plan for the V1 cut procedure.

- ❑ **Right approach:** Watch YouTube videos of the specific aircraft sim (Challenger 601, Learjet 45, etc.) to familiarize yourself with the cockpit layout. Know the V-speeds they will give you. Practice verbalizing every deviation and correction. Brief the ILS approach out loud before you fly it.

- ❑ **The Fix:** The sim profile is almost always sent in advance. Study it. Know the profile cold. Practice your ILS brief and your V1 cut callouts out loud before the day of the interview.

Mistake #6 — Poor Body Language and Lack of Eye Contact

Interviewers are evaluating you from the moment you walk in the door. Slouching, avoiding eye contact, crossing your arms, mumbling, or looking at the floor all send negative signals — even if your words are perfect.

In private and fractional aviation especially, you will be interacting with high-net-worth owners and executives on a daily basis. Companies want to see that you carry yourself with confidence and professionalism.

- ❑ **Sit up straight, lean slightly forward to show engagement, make steady eye contact with both interviewers, speak clearly and at a measured pace, and smile naturally. These are simple things that make a big difference.**

- ❑ **The Fix:** Practice your answers in front of a mirror or record yourself on video. Watch your posture, your eye contact, and your facial expressions. Most people are surprised by what they see.

Mistake #7 — Talking Too Much — or Too Little

Both extremes are problems. Candidates who ramble for five minutes on every answer lose the interviewer's attention. Candidates who give one-sentence answers seem unprepared and disengaged.

The ideal answer to most HR questions is 60 to 90 seconds when spoken. TMAAT answers can be up to 2 minutes. Technical answers should be as concise as possible while being complete.

- ❑ **Too long:** Going on for 4-5 minutes with side stories, tangents, and unnecessary background details.



❑ **Too short:** Answering “Why do you want to fly for us?” with “I like the company and the schedule.”

❑ **Right length:** A clear, structured answer that covers the key points and stops when the point has been made.

❑ **The Fix:** Time yourself when you practice. Record yourself and play it back. If you go over 2 minutes on any answer, cut it. If you are under 30 seconds, add more specific detail.

Mistake #8 — Not Having Questions Ready for the Interviewers

At the end of almost every interview, you will be asked: “Do you have any questions for us?” Saying “No, I think you covered everything” is a missed opportunity. It signals low interest and low preparation.

Having thoughtful questions ready shows that you did your research, you are genuinely interested, and you are evaluating them as much as they are evaluating you. This changes the dynamic of the conversation in your favor.

❑ **Strong questions to ask:** “What does the training pipeline look like for new hires and what can I do to set myself up for success?” / “What do the pilots who have been here the longest say they love most about the company?” / “How would you describe the culture between crews on long trips?”

⚠ **Never ask about salary, days off, or vacation in a first interview. Those conversations come after you have the offer.**

❑ **The Fix:** Prepare 3-4 genuine questions before every interview. Write them down and bring them with you. It is perfectly acceptable to glance at your notes.

Mistake #9 — Showing Arrogance or Overconfidence

There is a fine line between confidence and arrogance. Confidence is attractive in a pilot. Arrogance is a red flag. Companies want pilots who are self-assured but also coachable, humble, and aware of their limitations.

Arrogance shows up in subtle ways: dismissing the importance of the interview, claiming to already know everything, speaking negatively about less experienced pilots, or making it clear that you are doing the company a favor by applying.

❑ **Arrogant:** I have 8,000 hours and I’ve pretty much seen everything. Training should be straightforward for me.

❑ **Confident and humble:** I bring a lot of experience to this role and I’m excited to apply it here. At the same time, I know every operation has its own culture and procedures, and I’m genuinely looking forward to learning the right way to do things in your environment.

❑ **The Fix:** Always pair your strengths with openness to learning. Show that you are confident in your abilities AND aware that there is always more to learn.

Mistake #10 — Freezing on Technical Questions



Technical questions can come at any point in the interview — not just in a dedicated technical section. Some interviewers weave them naturally into the conversation. “You mentioned flying into JFK — what are the holding speed restrictions at 14,000 feet?”

The worst response is silence, followed by a panicked guess. A much better response is to show your thought process, even if you do not have the exact answer immediately.

- ❑ **Wrong approach:** Freezing, saying “I’m not sure” and moving on without attempting an answer.

- ❑ **Right approach:** “At 14,000 feet under ICAO rules, the max holding speed is 230 knots. Above 14,000 it increases to 265 knots. I believe under FAA rules it is similar but let me think through that —” and then reason through it.

- ❑ **Interviewers are not always looking for the perfect answer. They are looking for how you handle uncertainty. Thinking out loud and reasoning through a problem is far better than silence or a random guess.**

- ❑ **The Fix:** Review Chapter 7 (Technical Study Guide), Chapter 8 (Weather), and Chapter 9 (Regulations) in the weeks before your interview. Do not try to memorize everything — understand the concepts so you can reason through them.

Mistake #11 — Dressing Inappropriately

Aviation interviews are professional environments. You are applying to be the face of the company to high-value clients and passengers. How you dress signals how seriously you take the opportunity.

The standard for pilot interviews is business professional. For men: a dark suit, white or light blue dress shirt, conservative tie, polished dress shoes. For women: a dark business suit or professional dress, conservative and polished.

- ⚠ **Do not show up in business casual, khakis, or an open collar shirt. Even if the company culture is relaxed, the interview is formal. You can always dress down after you get hired.**

- ❑ **Lay out your interview clothes the night before. Make sure everything is pressed, clean, and fits well. Shine your shoes. Get a haircut the week before — not the day of. These small details matter more than most people think.**

- ❑ **The Fix:** When in doubt, overdress. No interviewer has ever eliminated a candidate for being too well dressed. Many have eliminated candidates for appearing sloppy or unprepared.

Mistake #12 — Not Being Ready to Discuss Weaknesses Honestly

“What are your weaknesses?” is one of the most feared questions in any interview. Most candidates try to dodge it with fake weaknesses: “I work too hard” or “I’m a perfectionist.” Interviewers have heard these a thousand times. They are not impressed.



A genuine, self-aware answer about a real weakness — paired with what you are doing to address it — is far more impressive than a clichéd non-answer.

❑ **Cliché answer:** My biggest weakness is that I care too much about my work and sometimes put in too many hours.

❑ **Honest and self-aware:** Early in my career I struggled with delegating. I wanted to control every aspect of the flight and sometimes that created unnecessary workload for me and reduced my FO's engagement. I recognized this pattern, started actively involving my FOs in decision-making, and I've seen a significant improvement in crew performance and my own situational awareness as a result.

❑ **The Fix:** Choose a real weakness that is not a core safety competency. Pair it with specific steps you have taken or are taking to improve. This shows self-awareness and a growth mindset — both of which interviewers value highly.

Mistake #13 — Arriving Late or Unprepared Logistically

This one should be obvious — but it happens. Traffic, wrong building, parking problems, forgetting a document — all of these create stress before the interview even starts. A stressed candidate performs worse.

Most companies provide detailed instructions in their pre-arrival email. Read it thoroughly. Know exactly where you are going, how long it takes to get there, where to park, and what documents you need to bring.

⚠ **Plan to arrive 20-30 minutes early. If you arrive too early, wait in your car or a nearby coffee shop. Walking in 30+ minutes early can also create awkwardness. Aim for 10-15 minutes early at the reception desk.**

❑ **The Fix:** The night before: confirm the address, plan your route, lay out all your documents (logbooks, certificates, medical, passport, licenses), and set two alarms. Treat the interview morning like an early departure — no rushing, no surprises.

Mistake #14 — Failing to Follow Up After the Interview

Most candidates walk out of an interview and wait. The best candidates send a brief, professional thank-you email within 24 hours. This is a small gesture that reinforces your interest and professionalism, and it keeps your name in the interviewer's mind.

The email does not need to be long. Two or three sentences is enough. Thank them for their time, mention one specific thing from the conversation that excited you, and reaffirm your interest in the position.

❑ **Example thank-you email:** Subject: Thank You — [Your Name] — Pilot Interview [Date]. Dear [Interviewer Name], thank you for the time you invested in meeting with me today. The conversation about your dedicated crew program and the culture you have built confirmed everything that drew me to this opportunity. I am genuinely excited about the possibility of joining the team and I look forward to hearing from you. Best regards, [Your Name].



□ **The Fix:** Get the name and email address of your interviewers before you leave. If you cannot get their email, send the thank-you through the recruiter. Send it within 24 hours — not a week later.

Mistake #15 — Not Practicing Out Loud

This is the most common and most costly mistake of all. Most candidates prepare by reading their answers in their head. This feels like preparation — but it is not. The interview is a spoken performance. Reading and speaking are completely different skills.

When you practice only in your head, your answers sound perfect. The moment you say them out loud for the first time — under pressure, in front of two strangers — you stumble, you lose your train of thought, you say “um” twenty times, and you realize your answer makes no sense.

The pilots who perform best in interviews are the ones who have said every answer out loud at least ten times before walking in the door.

⚠ **Thinking through an answer in your head does NOT count as practice. You must say it out loud, out of your chair, in a professional tone, as if you are actually in the interview.**

□ **Find a partner — a fellow pilot, a friend, your spouse — and do a full mock interview. If no one is available, record yourself on your phone and watch it back. You will immediately see where you need to improve.**

□ **The Fix:** In the two weeks before your interview, practice at least 5 STAR answers and your top 10 HR answers out loud every day. On the night before, do one final run-through of your most important answers. Go to bed early. Show up rested and ready.

□ **The 15 Mistakes — Quick Reference**

Here is a quick summary of every mistake covered in this chapter. Review this list the night before your interview.

- 1.** Not researching the company
- 2.** Giving vague answers without specific details
- 3.** Badmouthing a previous employer
- 4.** Lying or exaggerating on your application or in the interview
- 5.** Not preparing for the simulator
- 6.** Poor body language and lack of eye contact
- 7.** Talking too much — or too little
- 8.** Not having questions ready for the interviewers
- 9.** Showing arrogance or overconfidence



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10. Freezing on technical questions
 11. Dressing inappropriately
 12. Not being ready to discuss weaknesses honestly
 13. Arriving late or unprepared logistically
 14. Failing to follow up after the interview
 15. Not practicing out loud

☐ **If you have read this chapter carefully and addressed each of these mistakes in your preparation, you are already better prepared than the majority of candidates who will walk into that interview room.**



Chapter 6

TMAAT — Behavioral Questions

□ **TMAAT = Tell Me About A Time. Use the STAR method: Situation, Task, Action, Result. Be specific: aircraft type, airport IATA code, your role (PF/PM), weather, and YOUR specific actions. Practice your stories out loud before the interview.**

□ CRM, Crew & Conflict

1. TMAAT you flew with a difficult crewmember.
2. TMAAT you had to resolve a conflict between crewmembers.
3. TMAAT you worked as a team to accomplish a goal with someone you did not get along with.
4. TMAAT you had a conflict with a captain and how did you resolve it.
5. TMAAT you had friction with another pilot in flight and how did you handle it.
6. TMAAT you had to change your approach to dealing with a coworker's behavior.
7. TMAAT you had a stressful flight and you helped the Captain make better decisions.
8. TMAAT you corrected a coworker who was not following standards/rules.
9. TMAAT someone broke a rule or SOP in front of you.
10. TMAAT you intentionally broke a rule or company SOP.
11. TMAAT you were asked to do something you didn't agree with.
12. TMAAT someone made a decision/policy you didn't agree with and how you dealt with it.
13. TMAAT you corrected either a leader or instructor.
14. TMAAT you led a team with diversified perspectives to reach a goal or accomplish a task.
15. TMAAT you had a disagreement with your captain and had to challenge him/her.
16. TMAAT you had to say no to a captain.
17. TMAAT you had to convince the other pilot.



18. TMAAT you had to pass important information to someone or a group of people.

19. TMAAT you had a communication problem / misunderstanding — how did you deal with it?

⚠ Safety, Emergencies & Decision-Making

1. TMAAT you had an emergency.

2. TMAAT you handled a significant emergency in flight or helped back up the Captain during an emergency.

3. TMAAT you had a particularly stressful event and how you dealt with it.

4. TMAAT you made a decision too quickly.

5. TMAAT you made a mistake and what did you learn?

6. TMAAT you had to make a critical decision under pressure.

7. TMAAT you had to change or modify your plans.

8. TMAAT you had incomplete information but still had to make a decision.

9. TMAAT multiple threats occurred simultaneously — how did you prioritize and respond?

10. TMAAT you had to deal with factors outside of SOP.

11. TMAAT you had to think outside the box / deal with complicated information.

12. TMAAT you identified a threat before it became a problem.

13. TMAAT you had to deviate from SOPs or any normal procedure to solve a problem.

☐ Leadership, Growth & Above & Beyond

1. TMAAT you went above and beyond.

2. TMAAT you did the right thing because it was the right thing to do.

3. TMAAT you worked hard to achieve a professional goal.

4. TMAAT you had to deal with or create change.

5. TMAAT you made a positive change to company culture.



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6. TMAAT you were proactive in getting a professional job to which you aspired.
 7. TMAAT you did something that gave you a sense of accomplishment.
 8. TMAAT you experienced adversity and how you overcame it.
 9. TMAAT you lost credibility and what did you do to restore it.
 10. TMAAT you showed leadership.
 11. TMAAT you needed to change something in your company.
 12. TMAAT you demonstrated commitment to your work — above and beyond.
 13. TMAAT you made a decision and stuck by it.
 14. TMAAT you stayed back to make a decision.
 15. TMAAT you got other team members involved to make a decision.

☐ Mentoring, Teaching & Encouraging Others

1. TMAAT you helped/encouraged someone to achieve or do more.
2. TMAAT you helped someone as an instructor.
3. TMAAT you offered encouragement either to a crew member or a passenger.
4. TMAAT you mentored a peer.
5. TMAAT you gave someone guidance and how it helped them.
6. TMAAT you gave praise to a coworker.
7. TMAAT you received praise from a peer or co-worker.
8. TMAAT a CA/leader that you admire and how have you incorporated their traits into your leadership skills.
9. TMAAT you requested feedback from others.
10. TMAAT you took inputs / feedback from other pilots or team members.

☐ Customer Service

1. TMAAT you provided excellent / exceptional customer service.



2. TMAAT you went above and beyond for a customer / went out of your way for a customer.

3. TMAAT you had to deal with an upset or difficult passenger.

4. TMAAT you had a really awful client/customer on your airplane — how did you resolve it?

5. TMAAT you helped a customer directly.

6. TMAAT you provided a positive experience for your passengers.

□ Adaptability & Extra Duties

1. TMAAT you had to accomplish a task that was outside your duties or purview.

2. TMAAT you were asked to do something outside of your core responsibilities — what was the outcome?

3. TMAAT you had to take a leadership position unexpectedly.

4. TMAAT you had to quickly build a rapport with somebody.

5. TMAAT you had to quickly learn a new skill — how did you handle that?

6. TMAAT you had to deal with change in the industry.



Chapter 7

Technical Knowledge — General Study Guide

□ This chapter covers technical topics commonly asked at airline, cargo, fractional, and corporate aviation interviews worldwide. Review these concepts thoroughly and be prepared to explain them clearly and concisely.

RVSM — Reduced Vertical Separation Minima

Applies from FL290 to FL410.

Rate of climb/descent: 500 ft/min to 1,000 ft/min.

Cannot overshoot assigned level by more than +150 ft.

Altimeter check on the ground: not more than 200 ft error.

Flight plan: include letter “W” in equipment field.

Communication failure in RVSM: if deviation less than 10 nm — maintain flight level; offset 1-2 nm to the right for wake turbulence.

Deviation more than 10 nm: Eastbound — climb 300 ft if right, descend 300 ft if left.

Westbound — descend 300 ft if right, climb 300 ft if left.

RNAV — Area Navigation

Flight between 2 points without any radio station.

Advantages: time and fuel saving, reduces dependence on radar vectoring, more efficient use of airspace.

Waypoints defined by geographical position (latitude and longitude).

Two waypoint procedures: Fly-By (turn starts prior to reaching waypoint) and Fly-Over (fly exactly over the waypoint).

ETOPS — Extended Range Twin Engine Operations

Two-engine aircraft: in case of engine failure, must be able to fly and land at an adequate airport within the authorized time (air calm).

Standard ETOPS: 60 minutes. Can be extended to 207 minutes.

ETOPS up to 180 min: fire category 4 required.

ETOPS up to 207 min: fire category 7 required.

Three generators required for dispatch.

Required holding fuel: 15 min at 1,500 ft.

Adequate airport: satisfies aircraft performance (landing weight, equipment); must be available and anticipated 2 hours before use.

Suitable airport: adequate airport PLUS required ceiling and visibility, and safe landing with one engine inoperative.

Three Single-Engine Descent Strategies

Standard strategy: 300 kts / M.78.



Obstacle strategy: Green dot speed, MCT.

Fixed speed strategy (ETOPS): 320 kts / M.78 / MMO M.80 / 350 kts MCT.

Holding Speeds

ICAO: Up to 6,000 ft — 200 kts | 6,000 to 14,000 ft — 230 kts | Above 14,000 ft — 265 kts.

PAN OPS: Up to 14,000 ft — 230 kts | 14,000-20,000 ft — 240 kts | 20,000-34,000 ft — 265 kts | Above 34,000 ft — M.83.

Speed reduction for holding: 3 min before entering hold when ATC does not request.

Turn: 3 degrees per second | 25 degrees bank or follow flight director | 30 degrees bank maximum.

Timing: Up to FL140 — 1 min | Above FL140 — 1 min 30 sec.

Entries: Parallel (110°), Teardrop (70°), Direct.

Standard holding: all turns to the right. Non-standard holding: all turns to the left.

Procedure Turn 45/180 Degrees

First entry: outbound 45°, time 1 min or 45 sec with wings level, re-intercept inbound.

Second entry: outbound 80°, as soon as heading reached start turn 260° to re-intercept inbound.

Used when no suitable fix permits a direct entry onto an instrument approach.

Runway Threshold Stripes

18m wide — 4 stripes | 23m wide — 6 stripes | 30m wide — 8 stripes | 45m wide — 12 stripes | 60m wide — 16 stripes.

Take-off Path Segments

1st segment: starts at 35 ft (15 ft wet), until gear fully retracted. Gradient: 2 engines 2.4% | 3 engines 2.7% | 4 engines 3.0%.

2nd segment: starts after gear fully retracted until 400 ft (1,000 ft). Speed V2 or V2+10 kts, takeoff power. Gradient: 2 eng 2.4% | 3 eng 2.7% | 4 eng 3.0%.

3rd segment: starts after 400 ft (1,000 ft), speed V2, finishes when flaps fully retracted. Gradient: 2 eng 1.2% | 3 eng 1.4% | 4 eng 1.5%.

4th segment: starts after flaps fully retracted until 1,500 ft. Gradient: 2 eng 1.2% | 3 eng 1.4% | 4 eng 1.5%.

Approach BAN

If weather drops below minimums before the outer marker: must go around before passing the outer marker.

If already past the outer marker: can continue the approach until MDA.

Wake Turbulence Categories

Light (L): below 7,000 kg. Medium (M): 7,000 to 136,000 kg. Heavy (H): above 136,000 kg.

Note: 757 is classified as Heavy.



Departure separation: Light/Medium behind Heavy — 5 NM or 2 min.

Arrival separation: Medium behind Heavy — 2 min or 5 NM | Light behind Heavy — 3 min | Light/Medium behind Heavy — 5 NM.

ATC Light Signals

Steady Green: cleared for takeoff / cleared to land.

Flashing Green: cleared to taxi / return to land.

Steady Red: stop / give way to other aircraft and continue circling.

Flashing Red: taxi clear of landing area or runway in use / airport unsafe, do not land.

Flashing White: return to starting point on airport / land at this airport and proceed to apron.

Red Pyrotechnic: do not land for the time being.

Instrument Landing System (ILS)

Localizer range: $\pm 2.5^\circ$ each side (full width 5°). Range: 18 NM. Beyond 18 NM: $\pm 10^\circ$ at 18 NM, $\pm 35^\circ$ at 10 NM each side. Frequency: 108.1 to 119.1 MHz.

Glide Slope: range 10 NM. Frequencies: 329.15 to 335.0 MHz. Normal glide path: 3° .

Beam width: normally 1.4° . Loss of GS: approach can continue as non-precision approach.

PRM (Precision Runway Monitor): required for simultaneous close parallel approaches.

Close parallel = less than 4,300 ft between runway centerlines.

TCAS — Traffic Alert and Collision Avoidance System

Detects any aircraft with a transponder. Range: 30-40 NM. Altitude range: 9,900 ft above or below.

White triangle: proximate intruder. Yellow triangle: advisory intruder (TA) — aural "Traffic Traffic," about 40 sec.

Red triangle: real collision threat (RA) — aural voice, resolution advisory (vertical orders), about 25 sec.

RA procedure: AP OFF / FD OFF — fly orders — clear of conflict: FD ON / AP ON. Call out "TCAS, I HAVE CONTROL."

Runway Edge Lights

Classified by intensity: HIRL (High), MIRL (Medium), LIRL (Low).

Color: white until the last 600m (2,000 ft); then alternating yellow/white until the end; last lights are red.

Spacing between edge lights: 60m.

Center lights: white until last 900m (3,000 ft), then alternating yellow/white until last 300m, then red only.

CAT II/III spacing: longitudinal spacing 7.5m, 15m, or 30m. CAT II requires at least 30m.

CAT III: 7.5m and 15m.

Touchdown Zone Lights



Required for CAT II and III.

Extend from threshold for 900m longitudinal distance (not to exceed midpoint).

Three row lights, color: white.

Taxiway Lighting

Edge lights: blue. Used for LVO but not specific for CAT II/III.

Centerline: green. At RVR below 400m (1,312 ft), lateral spacing not to exceed 15m (7.5m in curves). In sensitive areas: alternating green and yellow.

Stop bars: red. Intervals of 3m. Used at RVR below 400m (1,312 ft). Required for all CAT III.

LVO — Low Visibility Operations

Visibility below 400m (1,312 ft) but not less than 150m (492 ft).

If no RVR available: pilots can make the assessment.

Minimum visibility for takeoff: 125m (410 ft).

Runway cannot be contaminated. Crosswind: less than 10 kts.

Takeoff from the beginning of runway. Static takeoff. TOGA power. Lights off. Must be in force.

RVR — Runway Visual Range

High-accuracy instrument. Measured at three points: touchdown, midpoint, and endpoint.

Reported up to three points. Starts detecting when below 1,500m.

METAR and TAF show RVR with "R" prefix before visibility value.

Approach Minimums (CAT I / II / III)

CAT I: DH 200 ft — RVR 550m at touchdown. Visibility 800m. Midpoint RVR not required.

CAT II: DH between 200-100 ft — RVR at least 300m at touchdown. Midpoint not required.

CAT IIIa: DH between 100-50 ft — RVR 200m touchdown, 150m midpoint, 50m rollout.

CAT IIIb: DH below 50 ft — RVR 50m at touchdown, midpoint, and rollout.

CAT IIIc: DH 0 ft — RVR 0m.

Wind Limitations — CAT II and CAT III

Headwind: 30 kts managed / 20 kts selected.

Max tailwind: 10 kts.

Max crosswind: 20 kts.

Flight Parameter Deviation Call-Outs

IAS: +10 kts / -5 kts — callout: SPEED.

Rate of descent 1,000 ft/min or more — callout: SINKRATE.

Pitch attitude: 10° up / 2.5° down — callout: PITCH.

Bank angle: 7° or more — callout: BANK ANGLE.



Localizer: 1/4 dot — callout: LOCALIZER.

Glide Slope: 1 dot — callout: GLIDE SLOPE.

CAT II Autoland

Automatic landing until 2,500 ft. Autobrake medium. Auto callout. Single engine approved. Flaps full or 3.

Fail Passive: pilot assumes control, computer cannot continue. Landing not completed automatically.

Fail Operational: automatic landing continues with remaining system; flare and landing completed automatically.

MEL — Minimum Equipment List

Cat A: rectified at 00:01 next day. Cat B: rectified in 3 days. Cat C: rectified in 10 days. Cat D: rectified in 120 days.

* = placard INOP | O = operation procedure required | M = maintenance procedure required.

CDL (Configuration Deviation List): part missing, operation restriction, performance penalties, maintenance actions.

Maintenance schedule types: Transit (each transit), Pre-flight (prior first flight), Daily check (every 36 hrs), Weekly check (every 8 days).

Types of Aquaplaning

Dynamic: due to standing water.

Viscous: surface is damp, thin film of fluid the tire cannot penetrate.

Reverted rubber (rubber reversion): long skid, rudder reversion, wet surface.

Control: release brakes if skid is sensed. On wet runway, reverse thrust is most effective.

Weather Terms

CAVOK: visibility equal or greater than 10 km, no clouds below 5,000 ft, no precipitation, no thunderstorm.

BECMG (Becoming): permanent change, phenomena starts after the specified time.

TEMPO: temporary variation.

TAF: issued for 9 hours, updated 4 times daily, international TAFs valid for 24 hours.

GPS — Global Positioning System

Needs 4 satellites: 2 establish lat/long, 1 confirms the fix, 1 gives altitude information.

Takeoff Distance Definitions

TORA: Take-Off Run Available — usable length of runway.

TORR: Take-Off Run Required.

Clearway: area at end of runway, 75m each side of extended centerline (can be water). Not defined surface.



TODA: Take-Off Distance Available = TORA + Clearway.

Stopway: unprepared surface at end of runway supporting the aircraft.

ASDA: Accelerate-Stop Distance Available = TORA + Stopway.

Balanced field: TODA = ASDA.

MEA (Minimum En-Route Altitude): lowest published altitude between radio fixes that meets obstacle clearance requirements.

MOCA (Minimum Obstacle Clearance Altitude): lowest altitude in effect between radio fixes on VOR.

MORA (Minimum Off-Route Altitude): derived by Jeppesen; provides obstacle clearance within 10 NM of route centerline.

RNP — Required Navigation Performance

Improved navigation capability. Depends on aircraft equipment and navigation infrastructure.

ICAO defines RNP values for four navigation phases: Oceanic, En-route, Terminal, Approach.

Other Navigation & Approach Systems

ALS (Approach Light System): basic means to transition from instrument to visual flight for landing.

VASI (Visual Glide Slope Indications): 3-5 NM during day, up to 20 NM at night.

ATIS (Automatic Terminal Information Service): continuous broadcast of recorded non-control information at high-activity terminals.

Braking Action Reports

Good: braking capability available, not limiting.

Fair/Medium: expect longer stopping distance.

Poor: very degraded braking conditions.

Nil: no braking action and poor directional control expected.

VREF & CRM

VREF: reference speed = $1.3 \times VSO$ (stall speed in landing configuration).

5 Focus Points of CRM Training: Situation Awareness, Communication Skills, Teamwork, Task Allocation, Decision-Making.

Engine Out SID

Must be performed with maximum bank of 15° at 1,500 ft, at green dot speed.

Landing Distance

Actual Landing Distance (ALD): measured from 50 ft above runway threshold until complete stop. Uses approach speed VLS ($1.23 \times VS$ configuration), maximum braking, ground spoiler operative.



VLS+5 for CAT II/III.

Required landing distance on wet runway: 115% of dry runway distance.

Failure Levels (ECAM)

Level 3: Safety / Red / Immediate action.

Level 2: Abnormal / Amber / Awareness.

Level 1: Degradation / Amber or None / Monitoring.

ATC Flight Plan Equipment Codes

Wake turbulence: H (Heavy, above 136,000 kg) | M (Medium, 7,000-136,000 kg) | L (Low, below 7,000 kg).

Equipment: S=Standard (VHF/VOR/ILS) | D=DME | W=RVSM | X=MNPS | R=RNP.

Other: SEL=SELCAL | OPR=Operator | STS=Hospital or engine inoperative.



□□ Special Operations — Flying in China: QFE & Metric Altimetry

Flying in China is one of the most unique operational experiences a professional pilot can have. Unlike the rest of the world, China uses a combination of QFE altimeter settings and metric altitudes that is unlike any other airspace system. If you have never operated there before, the learning curve is steep. If you have, this knowledge is a powerful differentiator in any international aviation interview.

This section explains exactly how the Chinese altimetry system works, how to use the conversion tables, and the critical mistakes that pilots make when they fly in China for the first time.

The Three Altimeter Settings — QNH, QFE, and QNE

QNH: Altimeter set to local sea level pressure. The altimeter reads altitude above mean sea level (MSL). This is the standard setting used worldwide for en-route and approach operations.

QFE: Altimeter set to the atmospheric pressure at the airport elevation. When set to QFE, the altimeter reads ZERO on the runway. Height above the airport is displayed directly — not altitude above sea level.

QNE: Standard pressure setting (1013.25 hPa / 29.92 inHg). Used above the transition altitude. The altimeter reads Flight Level (FL).

□ **The key difference: with QNH the altimeter reads your altitude above sea level. With QFE it reads your height above the airport. On the runway with QFE set correctly, your altimeter reads zero.**

Why China Uses QFE

China's civil aviation system was historically influenced by Soviet aviation standards, which used QFE as the primary altimeter setting for approach and landing.

The logic behind QFE: during approach and landing, the pilot reads height directly above the runway. There is no need to mentally subtract the airport elevation from the altitude readout to calculate height above terrain.

This simplifies the approach — the pilot knows at 300 meters on the altimeter, they are 300 meters above the runway. At zero, they are on the runway.

Despite global standardization efforts, China continues to use QFE below the transition level for domestic operations. International operations follow ICAO standards but crews must be fully familiar with QFE procedures.

Metric Altitudes — Meters Instead of Feet

China uses METERS for all altitude and height references below the transition level, and FLIGHT LEVELS above the transition altitude.

ATC clearances, approach plates, minimums, and traffic advisories are all given in meters. A clearance to "descend to 900 meters" means 900 meters QFE — 900 meters above the airport elevation.



This requires the crew to have a metric conversion table readily available and to think in meters, not feet, for the entire approach phase.

Feet to Meters Conversion — The Basics

1 foot = 0.3048 meters. 1 meter = 3.281 feet.

Quick mental conversion: divide feet by 3.3 to get approximate meters. Multiply meters by 3.3 to get approximate feet.

For precision operations, always use the official conversion table. Mental approximations are for situational awareness only.

Key Altitude Conversion Reference:

Feet	Meters	Common Use
100 ft	30 m	Decision Height CAT I reference
200 ft	61 m	Typical CAT I DH
300 ft	91 m	Stabilized approach check
500 ft	152 m	Config/speed check gate
600 ft	183 m	
700 ft	213 m	
1,000 ft	305 m	Stabilized approach gate
1,500 ft	457 m	
2,000 ft	610 m	Traffic pattern altitude reference
3,000 ft	914 m	Typical initial approach altitude
5,000 ft	1,524 m	
6,000 ft	1,829 m	Holding speed change level
10,000 ft	3,048 m	Speed restriction reference
14,000 ft	4,267 m	Holding speed change level
18,000 ft	5,486 m	
20,000 ft	6,096 m	
29,000 ft	8,839 m	China transition level reference



How the System Works in Practice — The Two Tables

Chinese operations require two separate reference tables that the crew uses during descent and approach.

TABLE 1 — En-route descent table (meters): Used from cruise level down to the transition level. ATC assigns altitudes in meters. The crew cross-checks their altimeter (set to QNE / 1013) against the metric conversion table to confirm they are at the correct flight level.

TABLE 2 — QFE approach table (meters): After passing the transition level and setting QFE, all altitude references switch to height above the airport in meters. The crew uses this table to cross-check approach gates, minimums, and traffic pattern heights.

The transition between the two tables happens at the transition level, which varies by airport in China. ATC will instruct you when to set QFE and the QFE value will be provided.

Transition Level and Transition Altitude in China

China uses a standardized transition altitude system. The transition altitude varies by region and airport elevation.

In most of eastern China (low elevation airports): transition altitude is typically 3,000 meters (approximately 9,843 ft) MSL.

At high elevation airports (western China, Tibet, Yunnan): the transition altitude is higher to account for terrain.

Above the transition level: standard pressure (QNE / 1013.25 hPa) is used and altitude is expressed in metric flight levels.

Below the transition level: QFE is set and altitude is expressed in meters above the airport.

QFE Setting Procedure

ATC will provide the QFE value for the destination airport, typically on the ATIS or during the approach clearance.

The QFE value is given in hectopascals (hPa). Both pilots set QFE on their altimeters simultaneously and cross-check.

After setting QFE: the altimeter should read approximately the airport elevation in meters above sea level MINUS the airport elevation — which should be close to zero if you are already on the ground, or should read your current height above the airport if airborne.

Cross-check: if you are at 3,000 meters QNH and the airport elevation is 50 meters, after setting QFE your altimeter should read approximately 2,950 meters.

Always verbally confirm the QFE setting with your crew: "QFE set, cross-checked."

Practical Approach Example — What It Looks Like in the Cockpit

Cruising at FL350 (metric FL equivalent). ATC begins descent: "Descend to 8,400 meters." Crew consults metric table: 8,400 m = approximately FL276.

Continuing descent. At transition level ATC instructs: "Set QFE 1008, cleared ILS approach runway 36."



Crew sets QFE 1008 on both altimeters, cross-checks, and confirms verbally.
From this point, all altitude callouts are in meters QFE — height above the airport.
Approach gates: 900m (approximately 3,000 ft) — configuration check. 600m — gear down, flaps approach. 300m — final config, stable.
Decision Height: typically 60 meters (approximately 200 ft) for a standard CAT I ILS.
At touchdown: altimeter reads zero (or very close to zero). This confirms QFE was set correctly.

Common Mistakes Western Pilots Make in China

Forgetting to switch from QNH to QFE at the transition level. The altimeter continues reading altitude above sea level, not height above the airport. Minimums will appear much higher than they should be — extremely dangerous at airports with high field elevation.
Mixing feet and meters mentally. A clearance to “maintain 900” in China means 900 METERS, not 900 feet. 900 meters is approximately 2,953 feet — a very different altitude.
Using the wrong table. Using the en-route metric table when you should be on the QFE approach table — or vice versa — creates dangerous altitude confusion.
Not briefing the QFE value before beginning the approach. Both pilots must set the same QFE value and cross-check before descending below the transition level.
Assuming the missed approach is flown in QFE. Some operators revert to QNH for the missed approach. Know your operator’s procedure before the flight.

⚠ The most dangerous mistake is descending below the transition level without setting QFE. If the airport is at 50 meters elevation, your altimeter with QNH set will read 50 meters when you are on the ground — not zero. You may believe you have 50 meters of height remaining when you have none. This error has contributed to serious incidents.

Why This Matters in an Interview

Questions about special operations — QFE, metric altimetry, high-altitude airports, RVSM, ETOPS — are common at airlines that operate internationally, especially in Asia, the Middle East, and regions with high-terrain airports.
Being able to explain the difference between QNH, QFE, and QNE clearly and accurately signals operational maturity and international experience.
Knowing how the Chinese two-table system works in practice — from personal experience or thorough study — demonstrates preparation that most candidates simply will not have.
If asked about China operations or metric altimetry, walk the interviewer through the system step by step: what QFE is, why China uses it, how the transition works, and what the common errors are. This level of detail is rare and impressive.

□ If you have personally flown in China, prepare a specific STAR story about that experience. It is a powerful differentiator in any international airline interview.

China Operations — Quick Reference

Altimeter setting below transition level: QFE (hPa).



Altitude units: METERS (not feet) below transition level.

Altimeter reads: height above airport (zero on the runway).

Transition level: varies by airport/region, typically 3,000 m in eastern China.

Above transition level: standard pressure (1013.25 hPa), metric flight levels.

Two tables required: (1) en-route metric descent table, (2) QFE approach table in meters.

Always cross-check QFE setting with both crew members before descending below transition level.

Conversion: 1 ft = 0.3048 m / 1 m = 3.281 ft. Quick rule: divide feet by 3.3 for meters.

✳ Ground De-Icing & Anti-Icing Procedures

Many professional pilots come from warm-weather countries — Brazil, the Middle East, Africa, Southeast Asia, the Caribbean — where snow and ice are simply not part of daily life. They build thousands of hours of solid flying experience without ever once standing next to an airplane in a snowstorm wondering what to do next.

This section exists because of that reality.

Early in a career that began in warm climates, the first exposure to cold-weather operations can be genuinely intimidating. The aircraft looks different covered in frost. The ground crew is rushing. Everyone around you seems to know exactly what is happening — and you are trying not to show that you do not.

One of the most important lessons learned early in cold-weather flying came not from a manual, but from a simple question. When the uncertainty of de-icing procedures became apparent, an instructor offered advice that proved invaluable:

□ **“Go find the operators who fly in cold weather every day. Ask them: what type of de-icing are you doing today? That one question will teach you more than any manual. And it will save your life until you build your own experience.”**

That advice proved correct. Asking experienced cold-weather crews — “What type of de-ice are you doing? What fluid? What are the holdover times today?” — became a habit that bridged the gap between theory and experience many times over.

This section gives you the foundation. The rest comes from asking the right questions and building your own experience in the field.

□ De-Icing vs. Anti-Icing — Understanding the Difference

De-Icing

De-icing is the process of REMOVING existing contamination (ice, snow, frost, slush) from the aircraft surfaces.

Uses heated fluid sprayed under pressure to melt and wash away the contamination.

De-icing alone does not provide protection against new contamination forming after treatment.



Type I fluid is most commonly used for de-icing due to its low viscosity and heating properties.

Anti-Icing

Anti-icing is the process of PREVENTING new contamination from forming on clean aircraft surfaces.

Applied after de-icing or directly to a clean aircraft when precipitation is expected.

Thicker, more viscous fluids (Type II, III, IV) are used for anti-icing because they stay on the surface longer.

Anti-icing provides a protection window called the HOLDOVER TIME — the estimated time the fluid remains effective.

The Two-Step Procedure

Step 1 — DE-ICE: Apply heated Type I fluid to remove all existing contamination. Aircraft must be clean — critical surfaces free of all ice, snow, and frost — before takeoff.

Step 2 — ANTI-ICE: Apply Type II, III, or IV fluid to protect clean surfaces during taxi and before takeoff.

The two-step procedure is standard when active precipitation is falling or expected during taxi.

Single-step procedure (anti-icing only) may be used when the aircraft is already clean and precipitation is light.

⚠ NEVER take off with frost, ice, or snow on critical surfaces — wings, control surfaces, engine inlets, sensors. Even a thin layer of frost on the wing can reduce lift by up to 30% and increase stall speed significantly. There are no exceptions to this rule.

□ The Complete De-Ice Procedure Flow

The following is the standard decision flow for ground de-icing operations. Follow these steps in sequence every time cold-weather conditions are present.

Step 1 — Complete All Normal Checklists: Complete all normal pre-departure checklists as you would on any other day. De-icing is an addition to your normal flow — not a replacement for it. Engines, systems, and avionics must be configured correctly before de-icing begins.

Step 2 — Assess Current Conditions: Evaluate conditions visually and using available weather data. Step outside and look at the aircraft. Check the METAR for current precipitation type, visibility, and temperature. Check the TAF for trends. The combination of visual assessment and weather data gives you the full picture.

Step 3 — Identify the Type of Precipitation: Using visual observation, METAR, and the FAA Weather Intensities Table, determine what you are dealing with: freezing rain,



freezing drizzle, snow, light snow, wet snow, sleet, frost, or freezing fog. Each type of precipitation has different characteristics and requires different fluid considerations.

Step 4 — Determine Precipitation Intensity: Using the FAA Weather Intensities Table, classify the precipitation as: HEAVY, MODERATE, LIGHT, or VERY LIGHT. Intensity affects both your fluid type selection and your holdover time. Heavier precipitation degrades fluid protection faster.

Step 5 — Check Temperature: Obtain the current Outside Air Temperature (OAT) from the METAR or the aircraft instruments. Temperature is critical — it determines which fluids are effective and which holdover times apply. Some fluids lose effectiveness below certain temperatures.

Step 6 — Check Available Fluid Types at the Airport: Contact ground operations or the FBO and ask: what de-ice fluid types are available at this airport? Not every airport stocks all four fluid types. Knowing what is available before you need it avoids surprises. This is also where the golden rule applies — ask the operators who fly here every day what they are using.

Step 7 — Select the Appropriate Fluid and Procedure: Based on precipitation type, intensity, temperature, and available fluids, select the appropriate procedure: single-step or two-step, and which fluid types to use. Consult the holdover time tables to determine how much time you have after treatment.

Step 8 — Coordinate with Ground Crew: Brief the de-ice crew on what you need: single or two-step, fluid types, areas to be treated. Confirm they will treat all critical surfaces: wings (upper and lower surfaces), horizontal stabilizer, vertical stabilizer, fuselage if required, engine inlets, and sensors (pitot tubes, AOA vanes, static ports).

Step 9 — Verify Clean Aircraft and Start Holdover Time Clock: After de-icing is complete, perform the clean aircraft check: visually confirm all critical surfaces are free of contamination. The holdover time clock starts when the LAST fluid application ends — not when de-icing began. Record the start time.

Step 10 — Takeoff Before Holdover Time Expires: Monitor conditions during taxi. If precipitation intensifies or holdover time is about to expire before takeoff, return for re-treatment. Never take off after holdover time has expired. When in doubt — get treated again.

□ **The pre-takeoff contamination check is your last line of defense. Before lining up on the runway, confirm visually (or have the FO confirm) that critical surfaces are still clean. If you cannot see the wings from the flight deck, ask ground crew or ATC for a visual check.**

□ **De-Ice Fluid Types — Type I, II, III & IV**

Type I — De-Icing Fluid



Color: Orange.

Composition: High concentration of propylene or ethylene glycol mixed with water, heated before application.

Primary use: DE-ICING — removing existing ice, frost, and snow from aircraft surfaces.

Characteristics: Low viscosity, flows off the aircraft quickly, provides minimal holdover time.

Effective temperature range: down to approximately -25°C (-13°F) depending on dilution.

Holdover time: very short — typically 3 to 45 minutes depending on conditions. Essentially provides no anti-ice protection in active precipitation.

When to use: first step of a two-step procedure when contamination is present.

Type II — Anti-Icing Fluid

Color: Clear or slightly straw/pale yellow.

Composition: Lower concentration of glycol with thickening agents (pseudoplastic fluid).

Primary use: ANTI-ICING — protecting clean surfaces from new contamination.

Characteristics: Thicker than Type I, stays on surfaces during taxi, shears off during takeoff roll due to aerodynamic forces (above approximately 100 kts).

Effective temperature range: down to approximately -25°C (-13°F).

Holdover time: significantly longer than Type I — up to 65 minutes in light snow conditions.

Important: Type II requires a minimum rotation speed to ensure the fluid shears off properly. Check the Aircraft Flight Manual (AFM) for minimum rotation speed requirements when Type II is used.

When to use: second step of a two-step procedure, applied after Type I has cleaned the aircraft.

Type III — Anti-Icing Fluid

Color: Yellow-green.

Composition: Similar to Type II but with different viscosity properties.

Primary use: ANTI-ICING for commuter/regional aircraft with lower rotation speeds.

Characteristics: Intermediate viscosity between Type I and Type II. Designed for aircraft that rotate at speeds too low for Type II to shear off properly.

Holdover time: similar to Type II.

When to use: anti-icing on commuter turboprops and regional jets with lower V-speeds.

Type IV — Anti-Icing Fluid

Color: Green.

Composition: Similar to Type II but with improved thickening agents for longer holdover times.

Primary use: ANTI-ICING — provides the longest holdover time of all fluid types.

Characteristics: Very thick, excellent adhesion to surfaces, longest protection window available.

Effective temperature range: down to approximately -25°C (-13°F).



Holdover time: the longest of all types — up to 80+ minutes in light snow conditions.
When to use: second step of two-step procedure when maximum protection time is needed, such as long taxi delays or heavy precipitation expected.
Most commonly used at major hubs and busy airports where taxi times can be long.

Fluid Type Quick Reference:

Type	Color	Primary Use
Type I	Orange	De-icing (remove contamination)
Type II	Clear / Pale Yellow	Anti-icing (longer holdover)
Type III	Yellow-Green	Anti-icing (low V-speed aircraft)
Type IV	Green	Anti-icing (maximum holdover time)

Holdover Time — What It Is and How to Use It

Definition and Importance

Holdover Time (HOT) is the ESTIMATED time that de-icing/anti-icing fluid will prevent the formation of frost or ice and the accumulation of snow on treated aircraft surfaces.

It is an ESTIMATE — not a guarantee. Actual protection time depends on precipitation rate, temperature, humidity, wind, and the specific fluid used.

Holdover time begins when the LAST fluid application ends.

If holdover time expires before takeoff: the aircraft must be re-inspected. If contamination is found, re-treatment is required.

Holdover time tables are published by the FAA, Transport Canada, and EASA. Always use the most current approved tables.

Factors That Reduce Holdover Time

Higher precipitation intensity (heavy snow reduces HOT significantly vs. light snow).

Higher precipitation rate (freezing rain degrades fluid faster than light drizzle).

Wind (accelerates fluid degradation).

Higher OAT (paradoxically, warmer temperatures near freezing can reduce HOT in some conditions).

Fluid dilution (Type I applied with too much water loses effectiveness faster).

Approximate Holdover Times — General Reference



Type I fluid: 1-45 minutes (very condition-dependent, essentially minimal protection in active precip).

Type II fluid: 15-65 minutes (light freezing drizzle to light snow).

Type IV fluid: 20-80+ minutes (light freezing drizzle to light snow).

In FREEZING RAIN: all holdover times are dramatically shorter. Type IV in light freezing rain: approximately 15-30 minutes.

In HEAVY SNOW: Type IV may provide only 20-30 minutes of protection.

Always consult the current official HOT tables for precise values — these are approximate guides only.

⚠ Holdover time tables are GUIDELINES, not guarantees. You are the final authority. If the aircraft looks contaminated before takeoff — regardless of whether the HOT has expired — you do not depart. Period.

□ FAA Weather Intensities Table — How to Use It

The FAA publishes a Weather Intensities Table that helps crews classify precipitation intensity for holdover time selection. It uses visibility and precipitation rate to classify conditions as Very Light, Light, Moderate, or Heavy.

Precipitation Classification — General Guidelines

VERY LIGHT: Scattered snowflakes or very light drizzle. Visibility greater than 1 mile. Minimal accumulation rate.

LIGHT: Visibility 5/8 to 1 mile in snow. Accumulation less than 1 inch per hour. Light freezing drizzle.

MODERATE: Visibility 5/16 to 5/8 mile in snow. Accumulation 1-3 inches per hour. Moderate freezing rain.

HEAVY: Visibility below 5/16 mile in snow. Accumulation more than 3 inches per hour. Heavy freezing rain.

Always cross-reference the METAR (visibility, precipitation type and intensity codes) with visual observation to classify conditions accurately.

□ When in doubt about precipitation intensity — always classify UP. If you cannot decide between light and moderate, use the moderate holdover time. The cost of re-treatment is always less than the cost of taking off with degraded protection.

□ The Golden Rule for Inexperienced Cold-Weather Pilots

If you are new to cold-weather operations — whether it is your first winter season or your first time flying into a snow-covered airport — there is one habit that will serve you better than any manual:

□ Find the operators who fly in cold weather every day. Ask them: “What type of de-icing are you doing today? What fluid? What are your holdover times in these conditions?”

No-Tower Operations (NONTOWERED Airports)

Operating at airports without an operating control tower is a fundamental skill for professional pilots. Whether you are flying cargo into a rural freight hub, positioning to a maintenance facility, or operating internationally at smaller airports, you must know the procedures, communication requirements, and lighting systems involved.

■ *No-tower operations are frequently asked in cargo and regional airline interviews. Know your CTAF procedures, pilot-controlled lighting steps, and what to do when you cannot obtain an IFR clearance on the ground.*

Weather Requirements

Before initiating any approach or departure at a nontowered airport, the crew must obtain current official weather and NOTAMS. Acceptable sources include:

- ACARS (Aircraft Communications Addressing and Reporting System)
- FSS — Flight Service Station
- AWOS — Automated Weather Observing System
- ASOS — Automated Surface Observing System

Never assume conditions are suitable based on inflight visual assessment alone. Always obtain official weather before committing to an approach.

Pilot-Controlled Lighting (PCL)

Many nontowered airports use radio-controlled lighting systems that allow pilots to activate and adjust runway lights from the cockpit by keying the aircraft microphone on the published frequency. All lighting systems at a given airport — whether it has one runway or multiple — operate on the same radio frequency.

Three intensity levels are available:

MICROPHONE CLICKS (within 5 seconds)	LIGHTING FUNCTION
7 clicks	Highest intensity
5 clicks	Medium intensity (or lower REIL / REIL off)
3 clicks	Lowest intensity (or lower REIL / REIL off)

Lighting remains illuminated for **15 minutes** from the most recent activation. It cannot be extinguished manually before the 15-minute period expires.

■ *Even if the runway lights are already on when you arrive, key the microphone as directed anyway. This resets the 15-minute clock and ensures full lighting duration for your approach and landing.*

Jeppesen approach charts note the type of lighting system associated with each runway, including the frequency used to activate it (e.g., "Activate on 122.8" or "Activate on 122.9 when Tower Not Available").

Communications at Nontowered Airports — CTAF

At airports without an operating control tower, radio communications between aircraft and visual separation are the primary methods of avoiding traffic conflicts. All pilots must **continuously monitor the CTAF (Common Traffic Advisory Frequency) when within 10 NM of a nontowered airport.**

When approaching or departing a nontowered airport, broadcast your position and intentions as follows:

FACILITY	FREQUENCY	OUTBOUND (Departing)	INBOUND (Arriving)
No tower / FSS open	CTAF	Before taxi; taking runway; clear of takeoff	10 miles out; downwind, base, final; clear of runway
No tower / FSS closed	CTAF (blind broadcast)	Before taxi; taking runway; clear of takeoff	10 miles out; downwind, base, final; clear of runway
UNICOM (no tower)	Published CTAF (or CTAF blind if unable)	Before taxi; taking runway; clear of takeoff	10 miles out; downwind, base, final; clear of runway
No tower / no FSS / no UNICOM	122.9 (blind broadcast)	Before taxi; taking runway; clear of takeoff	10 miles out; downwind, base, final; clear of runway

Example inbound position call:

"Cedar Rapids Muni Traffic, [Callsign] 10 miles east, 3,000 feet, VFR arrival straight-in Runway 27, Cedar Rapids Muni."

Obtaining a Departure Clearance (IFR)

When departing IFR from an airport without an operating control tower, make every effort to obtain a departure clearance before takeoff. Options include:

- Contact the FSS on the published frequency
- Use a Remote Communication Outlet (RCO) — an FSS with extended range
- Contact Center or Clearance Delivery directly by phone prior to departure

When operating from an airport without a control tower, the clearance should include a **release time** — specifying the earliest time the aircraft may depart. If a void time is received, the crew must be airborne before that time or cancel the clearance and contact ATC before attempting departure again.

Departing Without an IFR Clearance

If it is not possible to obtain an IFR departure clearance on the ground, a VFR takeoff is permissible **only if ALL of the following conditions are met:**

- The airport does not have operating ATC facilities and it is not otherwise possible to obtain an IFR clearance on the ground
- VFR weather conditions exist at the time of takeoff
- The flight remains in VFR conditions at all times while operating under VFR
- Weather conditions allow sufficient visibility to identify and avoid obstacles, maneuver using external visual references, and maintain minimum altitudes
- An IFR clearance is obtained as soon as practicable after takeoff — but under no circumstances farther than **50 NM** from the departure airport

■■ Departing VFR without a clearance is a last resort, not a convenience. Contact Flight Control or Dispatch before departure to ensure they advise ATC of the no-clearance departure. You must get IFR clearance within 50 NM — no exceptions.

Postflight — Closing the Flight Plan

When no FAA communication facility exists at the destination airport, it is the **Captain's responsibility** to close the IFR flight plan upon arrival. This can be done by:

- Contacting ATC directly on the appropriate frequency
- Contacting an FAA FSS by radio or phone
- Using Flight Control or Dispatch as a relay to ATC

Failure to close a flight plan will trigger a search and rescue response. This is a crew responsibility — do not assume it was handled automatically.

■■ Never leave a destination airport without confirming the IFR flight plan is closed. An open flight plan at an uncontrolled airport will result in search and rescue activation.

Common Interview Questions — No-Tower Operations

Be ready to answer these in any cargo, regional, or corporate interview:

- What is the CTAF and when do you begin monitoring it?
- How do you activate pilot-controlled lighting? What are the three intensity levels?
- How long does PCL stay on after activation?
- What are your options for obtaining an IFR clearance at a nontowered airport?
- Can you depart IFR without a clearance? Under what conditions?
- What is a void time and what happens if you miss it?
- Who is responsible for closing the IFR flight plan at a nontowered destination?

■ Interviewers at cargo airlines (UPS, FedEx, Atlas, ATSG) ask about nontowered operations frequently — cargo routes often serve smaller airports without towers. Knowing this cold shows operational awareness beyond the airline environment.



Experienced cold-weather crews at your destination or departure airport have current, real-world knowledge that no book can fully replicate. They know what is actually working in the conditions on the ground right now. They know which fluid the airport has in stock, which truck is available, and how long the taxi to the runway actually takes.

Asking this question is not a sign of weakness or inexperience. It is a sign of professionalism and good airmanship. Every experienced cold-weather pilot knows that conditions change constantly and that local knowledge is invaluable.

As your cold-weather experience grows, you will develop your own instincts and judgment. Until then — ask. The answer to that one question has saved many flights and many pilots.

□ Why This Matters in an Interview

Common Interview Questions on De-Icing

What are the types of anti-icing/de-icing fluids and when do you use each one?

What is holdover time and what factors affect it?

What is the difference between de-icing and anti-icing?

Walk me through your de-ice decision flow before departure.

What would you do if your holdover time expired during a long taxi?

What precipitation types have NO holdover time? (Answer: volcanic ash, sand/dust — these are not precipitation types that fluids protect against. Also: some very heavy freezing rain conditions exceed fluid capability entirely.)

What is the clean aircraft concept?

Where do you find holdover time tables?

□ **If you come from a warm-weather country and the interviewer asks about cold-weather operations, be honest about your experience level — but show that you know the procedures thoroughly. Knowledge and awareness of your own limitations is a strength, not a weakness.**

Chapter 8

Weather & Meteorology

□ **Weather questions appear in almost every technical interview. Know your METARs and TAFs cold. Be prepared to decode and brief them in real time.**

1. Read and decode a METAR and TAF.

2. What does T00890072 / T01610061 at the end of a METAR mean?

3. What does -RA mean on a METAR?



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4. What does RAE mean on a METAR?
 5. How do you convert Sea Level Pressure from a METAR?
 6. What does it mean when the temperature and dew point are the same?
 7. What does P stand for in the remarks section of a METAR? (e.g., P0005)
 8. What do the terms BR and HZ mean in a METAR?
 9. What does TSE051 mean in a METAR?
 10. What does ALQDS mean on a METAR?
 11. What does the \$ sign at the end of a METAR mean?
 12. How many times a day are TAFs issued?
 13. What is the difference between TEMPO and BECMG on a TAF?
 14. What is the forecast area for a TAF? What is its valid time?
 15. What is LLWS? What is your windshear escape maneuver?
 16. What does the D in D-ATIS stand for?
 17. What side of a thunderstorm do you want to fly around? How far away should you remain?
 18. What is the difference between a windshear caution vs. a warning?
 19. What would you take into consideration with windshear advisories?
 20. What is the jet stream and how do you tell its velocity on a weather chart?
 21. What is an occlusion front and what are the three types?
 22. What is the ITCZ?
 23. What is the Coriolis force and how does it affect wind in each hemisphere?
 24. In the northern hemisphere, how does wind circulate around a high-pressure system?
 25. What is an isobar / isotherm / isotach? What are isopleths?
 26. What weather will you expect after the TEMPO ends in a TAF?
 27. What are the types of precipitation that have no holdover time?

28. What are the two types of anti-ice fluid?
29. How long after a pre-takeoff contamination check do you have?
30. Define icing conditions.
31. What indications would you see if you flew through volcanic ash?
32. What is the number in a rectangular box on a high-level weather chart?
33. What is the dark line with an arrow on a high-level weather chart?
34. Decode a METAR with low visibility and precipitation.
35. What is the difference between a SIGMET and an AIRMET? Give examples of each.

■ De-Icing & Anti-Icing

36. What are the four types of de-ice/anti-ice fluids? What color is each one and when do you use them?
37. What is holdover time? What factors affect it?
38. Walk me through your complete de-ice decision flow before departure.
39. What is the pre-takeoff contamination check? When must it be performed and who is responsible?
40. What is the clean aircraft concept and why is it critical?
41. What precipitation types have no holdover time protection?
42. What is the two-step de-ice procedure and when is it required?
43. How do you classify precipitation intensity for de-ice purposes? What are the four categories?
44. Why does Type II fluid require a minimum rotation speed? What happens if you rotate too slowly?
45. Where do you find the holdover time tables and what authority publishes them?
46. Can you take off with frost on the wings if it is very thin and smooth?
47. What critical surfaces must be treated during a de-ice procedure?
48. When does the holdover time clock start — when de-icing begins or when it ends?



Chapter 9

Maps, Plates, Regulations & Airspace

□ **Know your plates inside and out. Be ready to brief an ILS approach, a departure, and a STAR. Regulatory knowledge shows you are professional and current.**

Maps, Plates & Airport Markings

1. Brief an ILS approach plate.
2. Brief a departure plate and its symbology.
3. What weather do we need to fly to this airport?
4. What is the symbol for the highest obstacle on a chart?
5. What is the MSA on this approach plate? What range does it cover?
6. What is TCH on a chart?
7. When do you go missed on an ILS approach?
8. What happens when the glide slope goes out on an ILS approach?
9. What does the D next to the localizer frequency on a chart indicate?
10. How is the final approach fix defined on an ILS?
11. Brief an ILS or LOC approach when glide slope is out of service.
12. How would you fly a PRM approach differently?
13. When circling, what are your circling radius limitations for Cat D minimums?
14. What is the difference between Minimum Safe Altitude and Minimum Sector Altitude?
15. What are the hollow arrows containing numbers at the beginning of an approach?
16. What speed/altitude do you set when cleared for a STAR?
17. What does the Maltese cross mean on an approach plate?
18. DME fixes — how do we identify them?



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19. When can you descend below your DA?
 20. What are the pink dots / pink circle on the taxi chart / airport diagram?
 21. What does the star with a circle on an airport diagram mean?
 22. What does ARP mean on an airport diagram?
 23. What does a hot spot look like on a Jepp taxi chart?
 24. What does a displaced threshold look like on a Jepp chart?
 25. Fly-over vs. fly-by waypoints — what are the symbols on a SID?
 26. Where can you find the lost comm procedure on the arrival plate?
 27. What is the distance between runway centerline markings and edge light spacing?
 28. What are lines of latitude / longitude?
 29. What is the prime meridian?
 30. Are METAR winds magnetic or true?

☐ Regulations & Fuel Requirements

1. What weather is required at an alternate?
2. When are you required to file a destination alternate airport?
3. What are the requirements for a departure alternate?
4. When would you need a takeoff alternate airport?
5. What is CDL? What is the difference between a CDL and MEL?
6. What difference does it make if visibility goes below minimums inside/outside the FAF?
7. Can you descend below DA with only the approach lights visible?
8. What conditions are required to be met to descend below MDA/DA?
9. What are standard takeoff minimums?
10. When doing an approach if you see the approach lights at DA, how much lower can you go?



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11. What is the maximum holding airspeed at 6,000 ft? At 14,000 ft? Above 14,000 ft?
 12. A TAF shows exactly 2,000 ft ceilings — would you need an alternate?
 13. Can you shoot an approach if it goes below minimums before and after the FAF?
 14. You are holding at 16,000 ft — what is the max holding airspeed and leg length?
 15. If ATC says “descend via,” what does that mean?
 16. When do you need a second alternate?
 17. What is your airspeed as you pass below 10,000 feet?
 18. What are company-derived minimums?
 19. What is required reporting to ATC when entering a hold?
 20. If RVR and visibility are both reported, which is controlling for commencing an approach?
 21. What are the three types of entries for holding? What are the three types of holding exits?
 22. What is RVR? Where is it measured?
 23. What are Part 121 international and domestic fuel requirements?
 24. What are Part 91 and Part 121 VFR minimums for takeoff?
 25. At what altitude do you switch from indicated airspeed to Mach? Why?
 26. What is ETOPS? What does it mean operationally?
 27. What is RVSM airspace and what equipment is required?
 28. What are the oxygen requirements for crew and passengers?
 29. What altitude must one pilot wear an O2 mask at all times?
 30. What are lost comm procedures?
 31. What are the three types of holding entries?
 32. DME Arc — if you fly a 15-mile arc for 60 degrees, how many miles have you traveled?



33. Are Cat II or III minimums used in determining whether you need a takeoff alternate?

34. What RVR do low visibility takeoffs begin?

35. Are we ever allowed to take off below charted takeoff minimums?

36. What is the additional safety margin factored into landing data for a clean and contaminated runway?



Chapter 10

Scenario-Based & Problem Solving

□ These questions test your decision-making under pressure. Always prioritize: **Aviate, Navigate, Communicate**. Think out loud. Show your reasoning process — they want to see how you think, not just the answer.

✈ Aerodynamics & Performance

1. List your airplane's V-speeds.
2. What is TALPA?
3. What is the difference between V_x and V_y ?
4. How do you calculate BINGO fuel?
5. What is V_1 ? How does it change with runway condition?
6. What is V_2 ? Can V_{MC} and V_2 be lower than V_1 ? Can V_1 be higher than V_{MCA} ?
7. What is V_{mcg} ?
8. What is the touchdown zone defined as?
9. Does a contaminated runway affect your V speeds?
10. What conditions would reduce the maximum takeoff weight?
11. How would a removed landing gear door affect performance before the flight?
12. How far out do you need to start your descent from 30,000 ft to 10,000 ft on a 3-degree glideslope?
13. Can you calculate top of descent from 33,000 ft? (3:1 rule)
14. What are the segments of climb? Define 1st through 4th segments and their gradients.
15. What is drift down speed?
16. What is wake turbulence?
17. How could you burn extra fuel en route to avoid max landing weight?
18. What factors affect our landing distances?



19. How do you calculate actual landing distance (ALD)? How are factored landings calculated?

20. Does density altitude change V1?

21. What is a balanced airfield?

22. What is screen height with engine failure at V1?

23. What is the minimum height you need to clear the runway if you have a V1 cut?

24. What is the additional safety margin for a wet/contaminated runway?

□ Emergency Scenarios

1. What would you do if you experienced an engine failure on short final?

2. What would you do if you receive a TCAS RA to climb but you're at your max altitude?

3. What are your actions if you lost an engine right at V1?

4. What would you do if you experienced windshear right after departure? On landing?

5. What would you do if after takeoff the FO and CA attitude indicators disagree?

6. What is the first thing you would do if the airplane depressurized at 30,000 ft?

7. Walk me through the procedure for rapid decompression.

8. What would you do if you experience cabin depressurization at 34,000 ft?

9. What would you do if you lost GPS signal after the last fix on a STAR?

10. What would you do if flying at FL370 and the autopilot disengages and won't reengage?

11. What would you do if at 800 ft on an ILS your engine starts on fire?

12. What would you do if the flight deck starts smoking during the takeoff roll?

13. What is the go-around profile?

14. If your mains touch down during a go-around, can you continue to execute one?

15. What would you do if you had a depressurization between two cities?



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16. Walk me through a rejected takeoff. What are RTO criteria?
 17. What would you do if you experienced windshear — escape procedure?
 18. What do you do for a compressor stall?
 19. What would you do if the METAR is reporting freezing rain?
 20. Walk me through what happens after you turn the battery switch on.
 21. What would you do if you got a cabin door unlocked fault over the Rockies?
 22. What would you do if flying over the Rockies and your plane pitches up violently?
 23. What would you do if tower asked you to depart from an intersection?
 24. What would you do if fire detection says there is a fire but you have no other signs?
 25. What would you do if weather deteriorates 45 min out from landing and you don't have an alternate filed?
 26. What would you do if you experienced an engine failure 3 kts before V1?
 27. What would you do if your FO calls runway in sight but you don't see it?
 28. What is your CFIT escape procedure?
 29. What is your windshear escape maneuver? When do you initiate it?
 30. Explain what you would do with an engine failure on a two-engine aircraft.
 31. What would you do if you lost an engine at 500 ft on a visual approach?
 32. Coming in on approach below 200 ft — tower says go around. What do you do?
 33. If you experience an engine failure at 1,500 ft with good weather — continue or go around?
 34. What are your considerations when operating out of high altitude airports?
 35. How does high density altitude, short runways, or high obstacles affect how much fuel you take?
 36. How would you handle an emergency descent over the Rockies?
 37. How would you manage an emergency as it relates to CRM?



38. What would you do if en-route requesting weather deviation but ATC wasn't responding?

39. What would you do if you noticed missing static wicks on your walk-around?

40. What would you do if the weather was below minimums and the airplane was on fire?

□ Operational Scenarios

1. You and your captain show up and the only lavatory is on MEL. What do you do?

2. What would you do if the Captain is flying an ILS and approaching full-scale deflection low on the GS and does not respond?

3. What would you do if hitting minimums on the approach and the Captain says continue?

4. What would you do if the glide slope goes out on a visual approach?

5. When can you descend if you're cleared for the approach but still 100 nm out?

6. What would you do if the FA told you a passenger stated the lavatory was broken?

7. What is the first climb segment?

8. What would you do if the CA wanted to fly the plane with a broken armrest?

9. How would you be an asset for the company?

10. What is the captain's role in customer service?

11. Would you accept a clearance to maintain 180 kts to a 4 nm final?

12. What is the max speed for a procedure turn?

13. What is the runway environment?

14. What is the minimum fuel requirement for an IFR flight?

15. How does an ILS work?

16. Walk me through a runway change after pushing back from the gate.

17. What is the captain's procedure during an RTO?

18. Hydroplaning formula?



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19. What do you need to see to legally land once at 100 ft above TDZE?
 20. How do engine anti-ice / wing anti-ice systems work?
 21. How do you start an engine with an inoperative APU?
 22. What anti/de-icing systems are on your current aircraft?
 23. What is required equipment for RVSM airspace?
 24. What is the runway lighting from the last 2,000 ft remaining?
 25. What color are taxiway lights?
 26. What is the difference between green and blue taxiway lights?
 27. What does CTAF stand for?
 28. What does ATIS stand for?
 29. What is the reciprocal of a 067 course?
 31. What are NATs? What is SLOP?
 32. For an oceanic flight, besides an ATC clearance are any other clearances required?
 33. What does LAHSO mean? What is the landing distance for LAHSO? Why would you decline a LAHSO?
 34. What would you do if you were holding short and realized you didn't have enough fuel?
 35. What speeds are associated with thrust reverser usage? When do you use thrust reversers?
 36. What is the definition of transition altitude and transition level?
 37. What is the difference between runway centerline markings and edge light spacing?
 38. What are Category 1 and Category 2 airspace?
 39. How many degrees of runway difference constitutes a circling procedure?
 40. If the FO and CA airspeed indicators were off by 20 kts, how would you decide which to follow?



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41. Is VV a ceiling?
 42. Give a generic takeoff briefing.
 43. Brief an ILS approach.
 44. Give an example position report over the NATs / on HF.
 45. What is spatial disorientation?
 46. What threats would you discuss before taking off from a high altitude airport?
 47. What are your crew rest requirements?
 48. What is a stable / stabilized approach?
 49. Describe windshear escape procedures.
 50. What is the critical engine?
 52. What is SLOP/NAT — when do you have to be back on course? Do we need permission?
 53. How would you brief a taxi?
 54. How is an FMS loaded differently for a transoceanic flight vs. a domestic flight?
 55. What are your company minimums for lower than standard takeoff minimums?
 56. Can we accept an RNAV STAR? How do we load it?
 57. What vertical mode do you use to descend to MDA?
 58. What altitude do you set in the box on an LNAV approach?
 59. When would you descend to the runway on an LNAV approach?
 60. What are the procedures for loading an ETOPS flight plan?
 61. As PM, where do you keep your hands and feet on takeoff and landing?
 62. What do you do if your holdover time ends?



□ Final Note

The questions in this guide represent real interview content from aviation companies around the world. Preparation, honesty, and professionalism are the keys to success. Good luck — you've got this.

Alcance Aviation

Your interview starts here.

Every pilot interview follows a pattern — and the pilots who prepare for that pattern are the ones who get the job. This guide condenses real questions from airline, cargo, fractional, and corporate interviews into ten focused chapters covering HR, behavioral, technical, and scenario-based content.

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| 1. Personal & Background | 2. Company Fit & Motivation |
| 3. Background Check & Records | 4. CRM, Safety & Airmanship |
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| 9. Maps, Plates, Regs & Airspace | 10. Scenario-Based & Problem Solving |

"The difference between a good pilot and a hired pilot is preparation. This book is that preparation."
